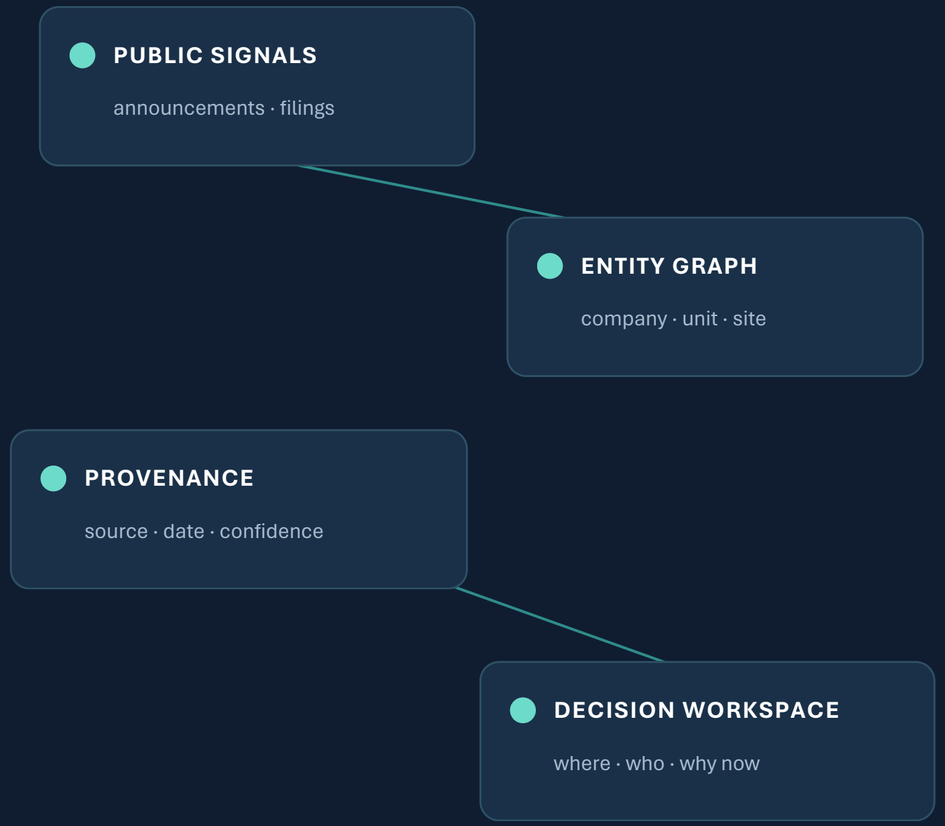
GCC ATLAS

INDIA GCC INTELLIGENCE

PRODUCT STRATEGY / OCTOBER 2026

From fragmented signals to confident decisions.

A source-linked intelligence workspace for the companies building, serving and studying India’s Global Capability Centres.



THE THESIS

Don’t sell another directory. Build the evidence layer behind market-entry and ecosystem decisions.

PREPARED BY DARSHAN SOLANKI • PRODUCT STRATEGY + WORKING PROTOTYPE

A $98.4B ecosystem is scaling faster than the information around it.

The market has crossed the “interesting niche” threshold. Decision data has not yet become consistently comparable.

2,117

GCCs in India

FY2026 · company-level count

3,728

GCC units

Multiple centres / units can sit under one GCC

$98.4B

Market revenue

FY2026 Nasscom–Zinnov estimate

31M sq. ft.

GCC leasing in 2025

Record annual volume reported by JLL

WHY THE WINDOW IS OPEN

GCC strategy is moving from low-cost delivery to enterprise capability.

As operating mandates grow more specialised, a static company list is less useful than a continuously updated view of expansion, talent, city strengths and operating conditions.

01 **Activity compounds**

Over 200 new GCCs entered India in the last two years, per JLL.

02 **Locations specialise**

Bengaluru leads on breadth; Hyderabad, Pune and Chennai have distinct vertical advantages.

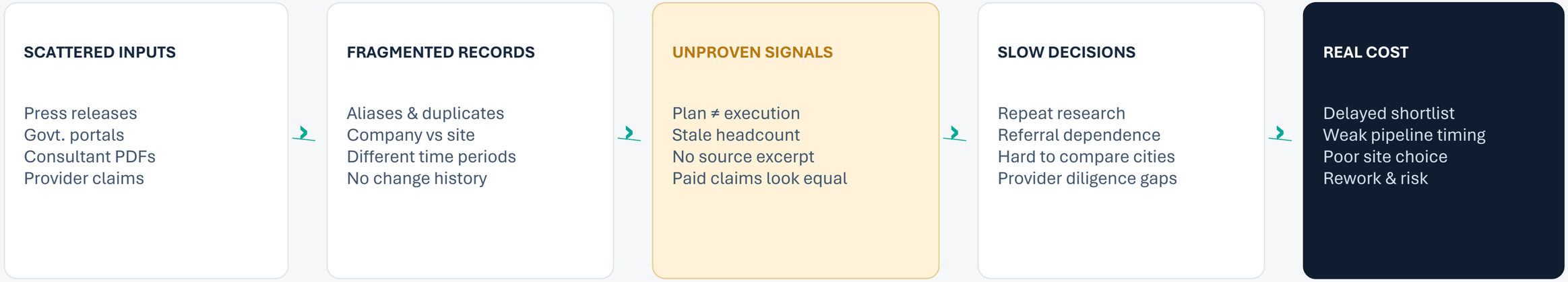
03 **Numbers need context**

Company count, centre count, office leasing and workforce are different units of analysis.

Sources: S1 Nasscom–Zinnov FY2026 (published May 2026); S2 JLL India GCC Guide release (17 Feb 2026). Metrics use their stated periods / definitions.

The bottleneck is not information availability. It is trustworthy join-up.

Government announcements, reports, filings and provider pages contain useful facts—but they do not share a common operating model.



The missing layer

A maintained evidence graph: claim → source → entity → location / event → decision.

DEFINITION	What is being counted—and when?
PROVENANCE	Who said it, where, and on what date?
STATUS	Is it planned, announced, launched or operating?
DECISION	Which action should this evidence change?

Discovery hypothesis—not a market benchmark: initial market maps may require multiple reports, calls and several rounds of manual reconciliation. Validate time-to-shortlist and correction rates with actual users.

The information gap sits between stakeholders—not inside just one team.

The same missing fact creates different costs for market entrants, service providers, city teams and advisers.

STAKEHOLDER	DAY-TO-DAY OWNER	WHERE ASYMMETRY HURTS	WHAT THEY USE TODAY
Global company entering India	CEO / India lead / strategy	Cannot build a credible city + operating-model shortlist	Advisor referrals, spreadsheets, bespoke consulting
Existing GCC leader	Site head / expansion / PMO	Peer benchmarks and location signals arrive late	Networks, brokers, periodic reports
GCC-facing provider	Sales / practice leader	Misses expansion triggers; outreach starts too late	Manual web research, CRM lists, warm referrals
State / investment agency	Investment promotion team	Hard to compare pipeline, cluster gaps and competing offers	Inbound enquiries, fragmented industry reporting
Advisor / implementation partner	GCC setup, legal, tax, HR	Rebuilds market evidence for each client; delivery claims hard to assess	Proprietary decks, calls and prior project memory

COMMON JOB TO BE DONE **Find the right company, city or partner—and understand the evidence well enough to act.**

“How many GCCs?” is unanswerable without a definition and an as-of date.

The difference between a GCC company and a GCC unit/site is material—not semantic.

FY2024

1,700+
GCCs

2,975+
centres

KPMG summary · FY2024

≠

FY2026

2,117
GCCs

3,728
GCC units

Nasscom–Zinnov · FY2026

≠

WHAT USERS SEE

Different
vendor totals

Different
coverage claims

Commercial platforms · Oct 2026

PRODUCT RULE

Never store “GCC count” as a naked number.

Every metric carries: definition · entity level · geography · period · source · as-of date · methodology.

S1: Nasscom–Zinnov FY2026. S4: KPMG GCC tax insights (25 Sep 2025) provides an FY2024 baseline. The last card summarises active vendor marketing claims; their counts should not be compared without checking scope.

Build the trust layer first. Add decision workflows where trust creates leverage.

Prioritisation is based on frequency of use, defensibility, feasibility and downstream decision value—not on feature count.

#	OPPORTUNITY	CORE DATA PRODUCT	IMPACT	FEASIBILITY	SEQUENCE
1	**Evidence-backed signal feed**	NEW / EXPANDING GCCs · WHO / WHERE / WHEN	High	High	**Start here**
2	**Entity & event graph**	PARENT ↔ GCC ↔ UNIT / SITE ↔ ANNOUNCEMENT	High	High	**Foundation**
3	**City + policy decision room**	SECTOR FIT · TALENT · SPACE · INCENTIVES	High	Medium	**Next**
4	**Provider capability & proof**	DELIVERY RECORD · REFERENCES · CASES	High	Low–medium	**After trust**
5	**Benchmarks & data APIs**	SALARY · RENT · COST · WORKFORCE	Very high	Low	**Later**
6	**Marketplace / introductions**	MATCHING · REFERRALS · TRANSACTIONS	Medium	Medium	**Not first**

WHY THIS ORDER **Signals drive recurring usage; the entity graph compounds value; decisions monetise trust.**

Important: salary, rent and incentive benchmarking is valuable but costly to normalise and keep current. Do not ship fake precision.

Beachhead: GCC-facing service-provider sales teams.

Recurring use, an identifiable budget owner and a measurable workflow make this a sharper first wedge than a broad “platform for everyone”.

FIRST PAYING USER

Head of growth / sales / practice lead

At GCC-facing providers:

- Commercial real estate
- Talent / RPO
- Payroll, tax & compliance
- GCC setup / BOT operators

Wants: “Which account moved, why now, and what should I do next?”

JOB TO BE DONE

Prioritise new / expanding GCCs; validate the trigger; prepare a relevant first conversation.

WHY THIS BUYER FIRST

Weekly account work; clear time-to-insight benefit; can measure qualified meetings and pipeline.

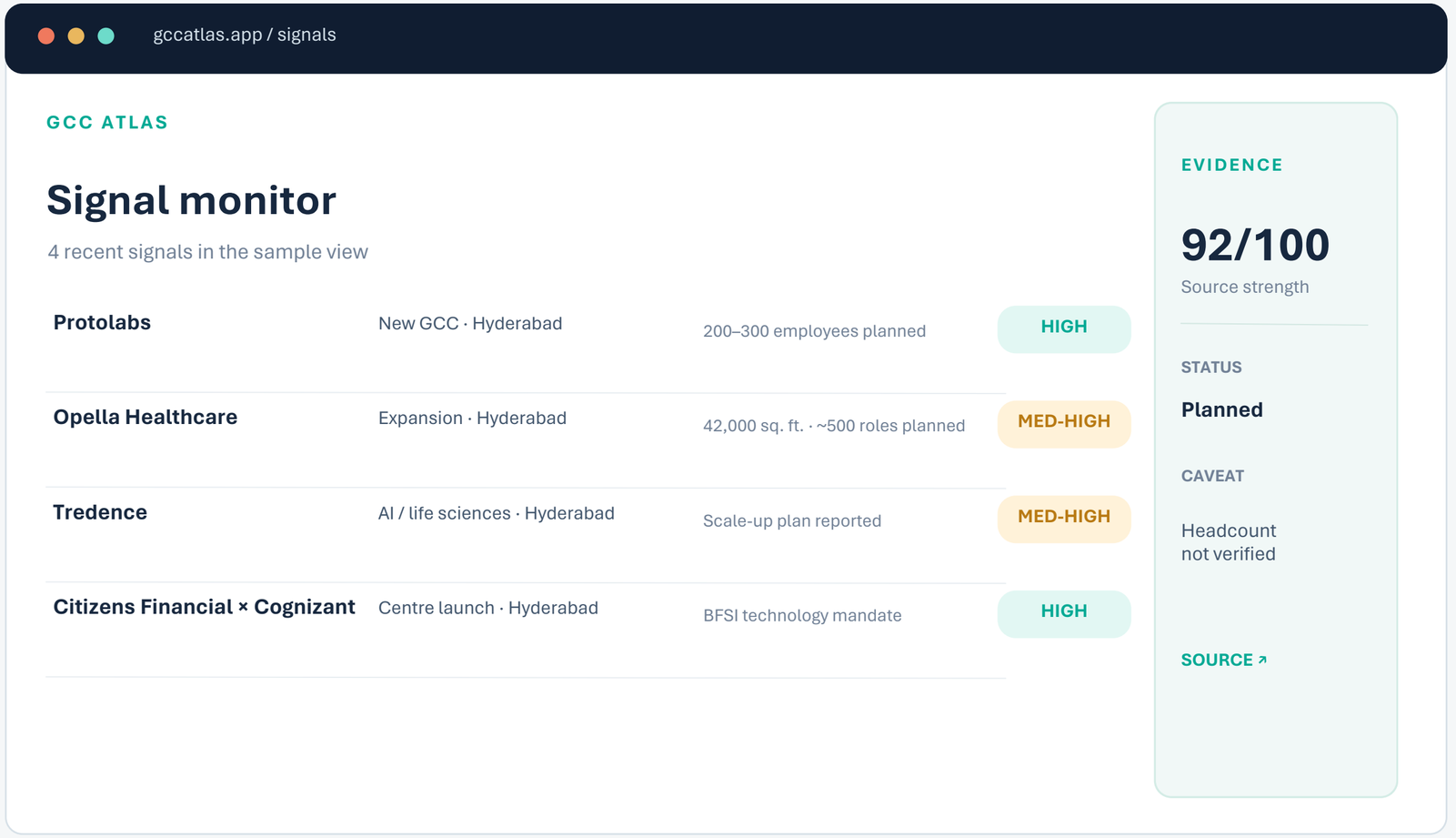
DESIGN PARTNERS

Market-entry advisers and 2–3 GCC operators test city/policy diligence without defining the initial SKU.

Illustrative exposure model to validate: 3 researchers × 4 hours/week × ₹1,500 loaded cost/hour × 48 weeks = ₹8.64L/year in research labour. Excludes missed-timing and poor-fit costs.

One evidence-backed workspace—from a public signal to a decision.

Three connected layers: an event feed for what changed, a profile for what is true, and a workbench for what to do.



01 Monitor

New setup, expansion, hiring, office and policy signals.

02 Verify

Entity resolution, status, confidence, source excerpt and change history.

03 Decide

Prioritised account lists, city comparisons and partner diligence briefs.

AI drafts; sources make it auditable.

The category is forming. Do not pretend the whitespace is empty.

GCC intelligence products already exist. The defensible position is independent evidence quality + a joined decision workflow.

ALTERNATIVE	STRENGTH	LIMITATION TO TEST	EXAMPLES	POSITION
Consultant reports	Deep synthesis; periodic cadence	A one-off report, PDF and bespoke budget		
Govt. / investment portals	Official policy and investment signals	State-by-state navigation; limited cross-city join-up		
Real estate / talent datasets	Strong domain depth and specialist benchmarks	One slice of the operating decision		
GCC intelligence platforms	Directories, signals and GTM intelligence	Direct competition; feature overlap is real		
GCC ATLAS	**Source-linked events + entity graph + decision workflows**	**Traceable facts, status history, missing-data prompts and independent ranking**		

Current direct-category examples (vendor-published positioning): Bamboo Reports, GCC Index, Sansovi GCC. Zinnov–Nasscom and JLL are essential primary market-intelligence sources—not just competitors.

Sources: S1–S4 and S6–S8. Capability statements are based on public websites; this is not a feature-by-feature independent audit.

AI should reduce research work—not become the source of truth.

Use automation where it is fast, deterministic controls where it matters, and human review for high-impact conflicts.



HUMAN-IN-THE-LOOP GATES — **High-impact claims · low-confidence extraction · duplicate/alias conflicts · policy eligibility · provider outcome claims**

AI returns candidate facts and summaries with source pointers. The database stores the source, status, reviewer and change record.

Core model: Company → Indian entity → GCC → unit/site → signal/event → source excerpt → reviewer / change history.

Make trusted market data easy to discover; charge for work it replaces.

Start with subscriptions tied to recurring workflow value. Add custom diligence and integrations only after the core graph is trusted.

PUBLIC LAYER

Discover

Free

- Basic GCC and city records
- Source links and key definitions
- Public signal highlights

TEAM WORKSPACE

Prioritise

Paid subscription

- Saved searches and alerts
- Segmented account / event lists
- Evidence-backed AI briefs
- Team notes and exports

ENTERPRISE

Integrate

Custom

- API / bulk data access
- Location and policy packs
- Private watchlists & research
- Governance / audit history

INITIAL REVENUE TEST

Paid pilot with 5–10 GCC-facing service providers

TRUST GUARDRAIL

No pay-to-rank provider scores.

Pricing and willingness-to-pay remain hypotheses; test against time-to-qualified-meeting, research hours saved and renewal—not click volume alone.

Prove trust and workflow value in 90 days—not market size by assertion.

The first milestone is not “2,000 records”. It is a small, accurate dataset that helps a buyer act faster.

DAYS 01–30

Validate the pain

5–10 design partners

- Interview provider sales leaders
- Observe current research workflow
- Build 20 signal dossiers by hand
- Baseline time-to-shortlist + errors

DAYS 31–60

Ship the workflow

Usable private beta

- Entity / site / event schema
- Signal feed + source lineage
- Saved search + brief generation
- Weekly correction / QA review

DAYS 61–90

Test willingness to pay

Pilot conversion decision

- Run 3–5 live account workflows
- Measure signal-to-meeting conversion
- Test paid pilot / renewal intent
- Prioritise city-policy expansion

PILOT METRICS

Coverage

% records with source + as-of date

Precision

% signals confirmed by reviewer

Freshness

median time from public release to capture

Value

research time saved + qualified meetings

Targets should be set after baseline measurement. “90% sourced” or “24-hour refresh” are targets to test—not existing performance claims.

One public announcement becomes a qualified action—not another saved link.

Illustrative walkthrough using a public Protolabs announcement in Hyderabad. The planned scale is not treated as actual hiring.

STEP 1 · DETECT

Protolabs

Planned Hyderabad GCC

200–300 employees (planned)

Public source: Invest Telangana
Published 16 Apr 2026

Capture URL + date + excerpt; normalise company, city, sector, event type and plan status.

SOURCE ↗

STEP 2 · VERIFY

What the evidence says

KNOWN	**A planned GCC in Hyderabad**
REPORTED SCALE	200–300 employees
SOURCE TYPE	State investment agency
UNKNOWN	Launch date, role mix, realised headcount

Do not overstate a plan as an operating fact.

STEP 3 · ACT

A provider-ready brief

Potential needs to investigate

- Engineering talent / specialist recruiting
- Office and workspace options
- Payroll, compliance and entity setup

Next action — **Confirm status + roles before outreach.**

VALUE HYPOTHESIS — **Better timing + relevant outreach + lower research effort. Measure it against current CRM / manual research.**

Claims are only as useful as their provenance.

Selected sources used in the market thesis, competitive landscape and prototype signal feed. All links are clickable.

S1 **Nasscom–Zinnov, GCC Landscape in India 2026**
2,117 GCCs; 3,728 units; $98.4B revenue; 2.36M professionals.

S2 **JLL, India GCC expansion hits record 31 million sq. ft. (17 Feb 2026)**
2025 GCC leasing, city specialisation and tier-II observations.

S3 **JLL, India office market 83.3 million sq. ft. in 2025 (15 Jan 2026)**
Whole-market leasing; keep separate from GCC-only leasing.

S4 **KPMG India, GCCs in India: Key Tax Insights (25 Sep 2025)**
FY2024 baseline and tax/regulatory context.

S5 **CBRE India, GCC leasing crosses 29 mn sq. ft. in CY2024 (6 Jan 2025)**
GCC leasing and Q4 city split; different time period from JLL FY2025.

S6 **Gujarat Government, GCC Policy 2025–30**
Official policy landing page; eligibility needs policy-level verification.

S7 **Invest Telangana, Protolabs planned GCC (16 Apr 2026)**
Signal-feed example; 200–300 employee scale reported as planned.

S8 **The Times of India, Hyderabad GCC announcements at BioAsia (17 Feb 2026)**
Opella / Tredence plans; future footprint and hiring are not realised outcomes.

S9 **Cognizant, Citizens Financial Group Hyderabad GCC announcement (15 Apr 2025)**
Company newsroom source for an announced/ launched BFSI technology centre.

S10 **Bamboo Reports, GCC GTM intelligence**
Direct category competitor: account intelligence and sales workflows.

S11 **GCC Index, product and methodology positioning**
Direct category competitor: public-event capture and real-time intelligence claims.

S12 **Sansovi GCC, directory and intelligence platform**
Direct category competitor: GCC directory, profiles and vertical intelligence.

S13 **ANSR, GCC setup and operations**
Provider profile: GCC-as-a-Service, BOT and lifecycle operations.

S14 **Mercer, GCC Pay benchmarking**
Specialist compensation benchmarking capability.

Caveats: vendor capabilities and counts are vendor-published claims; press releases can describe plans rather than completed activity. GCC companies ≠ GCC units ≠ physical offices ≠ leasing volume. Market shares are tied to source definitions and publication dates.